

Buying Smart



Warranty type: A carry-in warranty is definitely a big pain as far as bulky items such as laser printers are concerned. The warranty should be comprehensive and on-site.

Warranty period: The greater the warranty period, the better. It indicates that the manufacturer has greater faith in the product.

Suitability: Faster and higher quality printers are a lot costlier than slower ones. If you're in no hurry to take your printouts, or don't need excellent quality, set your sights a little lower. You'll end up saving big bucks that way.

After-sales service: With expensive items such as laser printers, it's a real bother to watch them crash or otherwise malfunction. Adding lousy customer service to that is like rubbing salt into a wound. Ask people who have already bought printers about their experiences with the customer-support staff. It might take some effort on your part, but is any day better than learning the hard way.

1/2 page Ver. AD

one that performed under par in this test was the HP Laserjet 1000—the image produced by this printer was of very low quality and looked washed out even when using the best quality mode.

In our next test, that is, the point size test, we printed a document containing varying font sizes and checked for the quality. All the printers performed well in this test.

Bulk printing test: We performed this test to check the efficiency of the printers when printing in large numbers. We printed 50 pages of text and checked if there were any paper jams or multiple sheet printouts. Most of the printers passed this test without errors. These included the Canon LBP 1210, Epson EPL-5900L, HP Laserjet 1200, Lexmark E210 and E322, Samsung ML-1210 and Wipro Laser 1540. But there were some printers that didn't perform well in this test. These included the HP Laserjet 1000 and the Canon LBP 1120. We experienced paper jams with the HP printer and the Canon LBP 1120 gave trouble with its multiple sheet pickups even when the papers were shuffled to prevent them from sticking.

Warranty and support

Warranty and support becomes an important consideration when buying a peripheral device. Most manufacturers provide a one-year warranty and the authorised service centres are usually spread across the country. The important thing is that the service centres should be spread across the country and not be concentrated in a single area. In this comparison, Wipro had the maximum reach with 170 service centres across 100 cities. HP too has a wide reach with 239 service centres across 80 cities. Canon provides the maximum warranty period at two years.



With an unmatched 239 service centres, HP printers are very customer friendly